

Walnut Hills Cemetery Trustee Meeting
Wednesday, March 24, 2010
Walnut Hills Cemetery Office

Trustees Present: Patsy Ostrander, Acting Chairperson, Mary Harris, and Donalda Hingston.
Associate Trustee: Madeleine Corcoran.

Staff Present: Erin Chute Gallentine, Francis Thomas and Heather Charles Lis

Guest: Liz Vizza

1. There were no deeds to sign.
2. The minutes from the 2/17 meeting were reviewed. D. Hingston moved to approve the minutes. M. Harris seconded. All in favor.
3. Discuss Fee Schedule for Lots and Services. E. Gallentine presented the draft fee schedule to the Trustees. The fees schedule was adjusted based on the Division's costs, the market and numerous discussion amongst the Trustees. The fee schedule reflects all burial options with an emphasis on the proposed build-out. The fee schedule will be distributed to the Trustees who were not present and discussed at the next meeting.
4. Review Draft Standards for Memorials and Markers. L. Vizza, Vizza Consulting, presented the draft Monument Design Standards to the Trustees and staff, and summarized the principles and key elements of the document, and the goal of having standards versus guidelines. L. Vizza, Trustees, and staff discussed the standards in detail and some comments and changes follow:
 - a. Natural boulders will be added with "granite, slate or bronze..."
 - b. Headstone dimensions will be added.
 - c. Honed black (and maybe red) stones will be permitted, but not highly polished.
 - d. F. Thomas will get some samples of different colors of stones to discuss issues with color further.
 - e. Anything outside these standards must be approved (by Cemetery Supervisor or Director, and possibly Trustees).
 - f. Everyone agreed that once the standards are complete, they should be publicized and distributed to relevant people (monument companies, funeral homes, etc.).
 - g. Slant marker language will be removed as there are few at Walnut Hills.
 - h. Trustees had mixed feelings about etchings, so they may be discouraged and subject to review.
 - i. Hinged covers, glass fronted cut outs, and breakable attachments will not be allowed, particularly where maintenance is a potential issue.
 - j. Special conditions language will remain.
 - k. A monument design committee is being considered for the future.
 - l. Language on monetary accounts will be corrected.
 - m. E. Gallentine likes the definitions section, and will suggest some terms to include.

- n. The policy for fake flowers and seasonal/holiday decorations needs to be clarified, and references to rules added.
 - o. Trustees and staff continued to discuss the monument design standards section, and agreed with most of the suggestions.
5. New Business.

The Trustees discussed recent vandalism at the Old Burying Ground and evidence of drinking at the Walnut Hills Cemetery. Thousands of dollars have been spent resetting turned over stones at the Old Burying Ground. Patsy moved and Donalda seconded a vote for The Walnut Hills Cemetery to spend \$10,000 out of account TW23 towards a seasonal park ranger who would include both the Walnut Hills Cemetery and the Old Burying Ground in his/her patrol route. All in favor. The rangers will look for evidence of any suspicious activity and also address the need for dogs to be leashed as necessary in both cemeteries.

A motion was made for adjournment. All in favor.

Submitted by H. Lis and E. Gallentine.